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Let's Learn Mental Models: First Principles Thinking

What is it?

Break a problem down to its most fundamental, indisputable truths, then reason upward from scratch rather than relying on analogy or convention.

How to Apply It

List every assumption you hold about the problem. Challenge each one: "Is this definitely true?" Discard inherited wisdom that cannot be verified, and rebuild your solution only from what survives.

Try This Today

Take a belief you hold about your work or life and ask "Why?" five times in a row, until you hit bedrock fact. You may be surprised what doesn't survive the test.

(Note: Visual for this post is from the book and is AI-generated using a detailed prompt.)

Ready to think more clearly? Grab your copy of Mental Models!

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